

B
PAPER

PRACTICE PAPER B · 1 HOUR · 50 MARKS

GCSE SPANISH READING

Edexcel · Higher tier

A full reading and understanding in spanish paper in the shape of the real one, with the mark scheme at the back.

PONCHO
SPANISH

NAME

DATE

PEARSON EDEXCEL · LEVEL 1/LEVEL 2 GCSE (9–1) SPANISH 1SP1

GCSE SPANISH

Paper 3 · Reading and understanding in Spanish

HIGHER TIER · PRACTICE PAPER B · 1SP1/3H

TIME ALLOWED	MAXIMUM MARK	PAPER REFERENCE
1 HOUR	50	1SP1/3H

MATERIALS

- You do not need any other materials.
- You must not use a dictionary.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer all questions in Sections A and B.
- Use black ink or ball-point pen.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided — there may be more space than you need.
- Some questions must be answered with a cross in a box.

INFORMATION

- The marks for each question are shown in brackets.
- There is a mark scheme at the back. Do not look at it until you have finished.

ADVICE

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

Antes de empezar

This is a Poncho practice paper. It follows the shape, the timings and the mark allocation of Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) Spanish 1SP1, Paper 3 · Reading and understanding in Spanish, but every text and every question in it is written by Poncho Spanish. It is not a past paper and it is not published by the exam board.

Sit it in one go, with a clock and without a dictionary. Mark it afterwards with the scheme at the back, and write down every word you did not know — that list is the most useful page in the whole paper.

Always check the current specification on your exam board's website: boards do update their documents.

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SECTION A READING COMPREHENSION

40 MARKS

1 HELPING A NEIGHBOUR

Read Leo's description of how he helped Sara.

Conozco a Sara desde el colegio. Vive enfrente de mi casa, donde vivo con mi madre y mi abuelo.

Sara tiene un perro marrón que normalmente duerme en el sofá o en el pasillo. Pero el martes no. Me llamó porque no lo encontraba.

Buscamos en el jardín, en la escalera y detrás del garaje. Al final apareció en el baño.

Complete the gap in each sentence using a word from the box below. There are more words than gaps.

classmate	cousin	bathroom	garage	garden	sofa	stairs

(a) Sara is Leo's ..... . (1)

(b) Normally, Sara's dog sleeps on the ..... . (1)

(c) They found the dog in the ..... . (1)

(Total for Question 1 = 3 marks)

2 SPORT AT SCHOOL

Read Nadia's article about sport in her school.

En mi instituto hay más alumnos que hacen deporte que hace dos años. Esto es porque ahora hay equipos mixtos, las pistas están abiertas al mediodía y no hay que pagar nada.

Durante el recreo los alumnos pueden jugar al fútbol, usar las mesas de ping-pong o simplemente sentarse al sol. Los profesores nos recomiendan movernos un poco cada hora, aunque sea caminando por el pasillo.

Todo el mundo cree que el deporte en el instituto es provechoso* y debería tener más horas.

** provechoso – ?*

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(a) Complete the sentences below.

Put a cross in the correct box for each question.

(i) The number of students doing sport has ... (1)

- ☐ **A** increased.
- ☐ **B** stayed the same.
- ☐ **C** fallen.

(ii) In Nadia's school the courts ... (1)

- ☐ **A** cost money.
- ☐ **B** open at midday.
- ☐ **C** are closed at break.

(iii) At break time, students can ... (1)

- ☐ **A** play table tennis.
- ☐ **B** do homework.
- ☐ **C** leave the school.

(iv) Teachers say students should ... (1)

- ☐ **A** move a little every hour.
- ☐ **B** join a team.
- ☐ **C** run every morning.

Put a cross in the correct box.

(b) Which of these is the best translation for the word provechoso? (1)

- ☐ **A** worthwhile
- ☐ **B** provisional
- ☐ **C** dangerous

(Total for Question 2 = 5 marks)

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3 A FILM AND ITS STAR

Read this review of a film and an actor.

Esta película cuenta una historia real sobre la música colombiana. Hay una chica que deja su pueblo tranquilo y se va a la capital, donde aprende a tocar el arpa y lo encuentra dificilísimo. ¡Le encanta la música! Después de verla, querrás escuchar discos de ese país.

(a) Complete the gap in each sentence using a word from the box below. There are more words than gaps.

true	quiet	difficult	sing	listen	study	travel

(i) The story is ..... . (1)

(ii) The girl finds the harp ..... . (1)

(iii) The film makes people want to ..... to music from Colombia. (1)

(b) The review continues and talks about the actor.

Esta joven actriz colombiana empezó en el teatro a los diez años. Tiene muchísimos seguidores en las redes, aunque publica muy poco. También aparece en una serie de televisión. Su personalidad es tranquila y seria, perfecta para el papel. ¡Si la ves actuar, te emocionarás!

(c) Complete the sentences below.

Put a cross in the correct box for each question.

(i) Now, the actor is ... (1)

- ☐ **A** ten years old.
- ☐ **B** a young woman.
- ☐ **C** an older woman.

(ii) She ... (1)

- ☐ **A** posts very little.
- ☐ **B** only works in the theatre.
- ☐ **C** has few followers.

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(d) Answer the following questions in English. You do not need to write in full sentences.

(i) What is the actor's personality like? (1 detail) **(1)**

(ii) What does the actor make people feel? **(1)**

(Total for Question 3 = 7 marks)

4 A CAMPING TRIP

Read this entry on a holiday forum.

¿Playa o ciudad? Para nosotros era una decisión difícil porque nos encantan los museos. Al final nos fuimos a la costa porque los niños necesitaban correr.

Los tres primeros días no se movieron del agua: nadaban por la mañana y por la tarde.

Lamentablemente, después llegó un viento que levantaba la arena* y no se podía ni abrir los ojos. Tuvimos que pasar dos días dentro del apartamento jugando a las cartas.

(a) Answer the following questions in English. You do not need to write in full sentences.

(i) What was the reason for going to the coast? **(1)**

(ii) How do we know the children enjoyed the first days? (1 detail) **(1)**

Put a cross in the correct box.

(b) Which of these is the best translation for the word arena? **(1)**

- ☐ **A** rain
- ☐ **B** sand
- ☐ **C** wave

(Total for Question 4 = 3 marks)

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5 IN THE FUTURE

Read Irene's and Marc's blogs about their future plans.

(a) What does Irene say about her future plans?

Mi sueño es dedicarme a la restauración de obras de arte. Mis padres me animan, aunque temen que haya pocas plazas. Para conseguirlo hace falta una carrera y después un máster.

Si no lo lograra, me daría rabia, pero podría trabajar en un archivo histórico y también me parecería apasionante.

Put a cross next to each one of the three correct statements.

Irene ... (3)

- ☐ **A** already restores works of art.
- ☐ **B** wants to restore works of art.
- ☐ **C** has parents who encourage her.
- ☐ **D** has been accepted on the master's course.
- ☐ **E** has to study abroad.
- ☐ **F** could also work in a historical archive.

(b) What does Marc tell us?

Complete the tables in English. You do not need to write in full sentences.

Soy bastante callado, así que odio la idea de pasar el día atendiendo al público. Siempre quise ser técnico* de sonido. Con este trabajo estaré detrás del escenario y viajaré con los grupos. Estoy en el último año y ya he grabado dos conciertos. Espero poder montar un pequeño estudio en casa de mis padres.

** técnico – technician*

(i) What he hates the idea of	(1)
(ii) Why he wants to be a sound technician (1 detail)	(1)
(iii) His current situation (1 detail)	(1)
(iv) His future plan (1 detail)	(1)

(Total for Question 5 = 7 marks)

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6 A CAFÉ REVIEW

Read Bruno's review of a café.

El sábado pasado fui por primera vez a Vereda, una cafetería argentina nada barata. Mi compañera de piso me recomendó las medialunas, y acertó de pleno.

El local es amplio y por la mañana hay sitio de sobra, aunque a partir de las cinco no cabe un alfiler. Abrió hace dos años y la dueña me dijo que todo el pan se hace allí mismo.

(a) What does Bruno say about the café?

Put a cross next to each one of the two correct statements.

The café Vereda ... (2)

- ☐ **A** is not cheap.
- ☐ **B** is small and cramped.
- ☐ **C** bakes its own bread.
- ☐ **D** opened ten years ago.

(b) The review continues.

Complete the following tables in English. You do not need to write in full sentences.

Antes de ir, yo pensaba que una cafetería así sería incómoda para trabajar. Resulta que es al revés: hay enchufes en todas las mesas y nadie te mira mal si te quedas dos horas, algo ideal para quien estudia, como yo.

En Vereda usan café de productores pequeños, muy distinto del que sirven las grandes cadenas. Volveré seguro. Abre todos los días menos los domingos hasta las nueve de la noche.

(i) What Bruno used to think about cafés like this one (1 detail)	(1)
(ii) Why the café suits students	(1)
(iii) What time the café closes	(1)

(Total for Question 6 = 5 marks)

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7 A VISIT TO GRANADA

Read this tourist brochure about Granada.

Debes empezar por el Albaicín*, un barrio de calles estrechas donde se come de tapas sin pagar de más. Para entender la historia de la ciudad, lo mejor es recorrer el palacio que está en la colina de enfrente. Puedes subir en microbús o en taxi, pero lo más agradable es ir caminando.

Granada no se aburre nunca. Hay conciertos en los patios, mercadillos y ferias de artesanía. Un lugar precioso es el mirador de San Nicolás. Allí todos disfrutan si llegan antes de que se ponga el sol.

Si vienes en junio, podrás ver el festival de música y danza, con espectáculos al aire libre.

Tu opinión es importante. Después del viaje, te pedimos que nos escribas una reseña.

** Albaicín – an old quarter of Granada*

(a) Complete the sentences below.

Put a cross in the correct box for each question.

(i) In the Albaicín you can … (1)

- ☐ **A** learn the city's history.
- ☐ **B** eat tapas without paying too much.
- ☐ **C** see a dance show.

(ii) The nicest way to get to the palace is … (1)

- ☐ **A** by minibus.
- ☐ **B** by taxi.
- ☐ **C** on foot.

(iii) At the mirador de San Nicolás people should … (1)

- ☐ **A** arrive before sunset.
- ☐ **B** book a table.
- ☐ **C** bring a picnic.

(b) Answer the following questions in English. You do not need to write in full sentences.

(i) What can you see in June? (1 detail) (1)

.....

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(ii) What are you asked to do after your trip? **(1)**

.....

(Total for Question 7 = 5 marks)

8 MY FAVOURITE ATHLETE

Read Iker's school report about his favourite athlete, Paula Vidal.

Soy Iker y mi deportista favorita es Paula Vidal. Creo que corre de una manera muy distinta a las demás. Lo que más me gusta es cómo administra las fuerzas: parece lenta y de repente no la alcanza nadie.

Paula nació en Zaragoza, es muy alta y siempre lleva una cinta azul en el pelo. Empezó a correr en el colegio y a los diecisiete quiso entrar en la selección, pero no la eligieron.

A pesar de eso, no lo dejó. En 2024 batió tres récords nacionales en una misma temporada y ahora la conoce todo el mundo.

La respeto porque dedica los lunes a entrenar a niñas de su barrio. Dice que de pequeña nadie le explicó cómo se entrena y no quiere que les pase lo mismo.

Answer the following questions in English. You do not need to write in full sentences.

(a) How does Iker describe the way Paula runs? (1 detail) **(1)**

.....

(b) How does Iker describe Paula's appearance? (1 detail) **(1)**

.....

(c) What happened when Paula tried to join the national team at seventeen? **(1)**

.....

(d) How do we know that Paula is well known? (1 detail) **(1)**

.....

(e) What does Paula do on Mondays, and why? **(1)**

.....

(Total for Question 8 = 5 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION A = 40 MARKS

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SECTION B TRANSLATION

10 MARKS

9 MY NEIGHBOURHOOD

Translate the following paragraph into English.

(10)

Me llamo Alba y vivo en un barrio tranquilo. Allí conocí a mi vecina, Rosa, en una fiesta de la calle. Todos los sábados voy al mercado mientras Rosa se queda en casa cuidando su huerto. Siempre nos ayudamos cuando tenemos problemas y compartimos la comida. Salvo cuando se trata de la música, nunca estamos en desacuerdo.

(Total for Question 9 = 10 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION B = 10 MARKS

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RESPUESTAS · MARK SCHEME

ANSWERS

Mark it honestly, one mark per correct answer unless the scheme says otherwise. Where an answer could be worded in more than one way, the scheme shows the idea the examiner is looking for.

ANSWERS · SECTION A

1 HELPING A NEIGHBOUR

(a) classmate

(b) sofa

(c) bathroom

2 SPORT AT SCHOOL

(a)(i) A — increased.

(a)(ii) B — open at midday.

(a)(iii) A — play table tennis.

(a)(iv) A — move a little every hour.

(b) A — worthwhile

3 A FILM AND ITS STAR

(a)(i) true

(a)(ii) difficult

(a)(iii) listen

(c)(i) B — a young woman.

(c)(ii) A — posts very little.

(d)(i) Calm / serious

(d)(ii) Moved / emotional

4 A CAMPING TRIP

(a)(i) The children needed to run (around)

(a)(ii) They did not move out of the water / they swam morning and afternoon

(b) B — sand

5 IN THE FUTURE

(a) B, C, F

(b)(i) Spending the day serving the public

(b)(ii) He will be behind the stage / he will travel with the bands

(b)(iii) He is in his final year / he has already recorded two concerts

(b)(iv) To set up a small studio at his parents' house

6 A CAFÉ REVIEW

(a) A, C

(b)(i) That it would be uncomfortable to work in

(b)(ii) There are plugs at every table / nobody minds if you stay two hours

(b)(iii) At nine (in the evening)

7 A VISIT TO GRANADA

(a)(i) B — eat tapas without paying too much.

(a)(ii) C — on foot.

(a)(iii) A — arrive before sunset.

(b)(i) A music and dance festival / open-air shows

(b)(ii) Write them a review

8 MY FAVOURITE ATHLETE

(a) Very differently from the others / she looks slow and suddenly nobody can catch her

(b) She is very tall / she always wears a blue ribbon in her hair

(c) She was not chosen / selected

(d) She broke three national records in one season / everybody knows her now

(e) She coaches girls from her neighbourhood, because nobody explained to her how to train when she was little

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ANSWERS · SECTION B

9 · MY NEIGHBOURHOOD

My name is Alba and I live in a quiet neighbourhood. I met my neighbour, Rosa, there at a street party. Every Saturday I go to the market while Rosa stays at home looking after her vegetable garden. We always help each other when we have problems and we share our food. Except when it comes to music, we never disagree.

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¡MUCHA SUERTE!

YOU'VE GOT THIS

Finished? Mark it, count the words you did not know and come back to this paper in a fortnight. The second time around is where the marks are.

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